Benjamin Rutledge

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Product-focused front-end engineer with 6+ years of commercial experience across agency and SaaS environments. I care about what gets built and why. Experienced working across the full spectrum, from fast-paced agency projects to enterprise SaaS where architectural decisions have long-term consequences. Opinionated where it matters: architecture, user experience, not shipping broken things and collaborative enough to know which hills aren't worth dying on.

EXPERIENCE

Front-End Developer - PD2X ***Nov 2022 - Present***

Delivered features across multiple SaaS products, working in a small cross-functional team of 3 front-end and 2 back-end developers.

- Developed and maintained features in React and TypeScript within complex proprietary design patterns, spanning multiple products
- Integrated REST APIs into the front end in Next.js, including work in the Next.js API layer (middleware and proxies), collaborating closely with .NET back-end developers to deliver robust end-to-end features
- Built customer-facing document generation features using React PDF, enabling vets to receive structured site visit reports and travellers to access personalised health briefs
- Designed UI components in Figma and implemented responsive layouts, bridging design and engineering in a lean team
- Reduced manual overhead in sprint workflows by automating Azure Boards ticket updates via GitHub Actions, improving team consistency and reducing context-switching
- Raised code quality across the front-end by introducing standardised branch naming conventions enforced via Husky pre-commit hooks and writing unit tests using Jest to maintain code reliability across a growing codebase
- Contributed to sprint planning by scoping work, writing user stories, and breaking down tasks - helping a small team stay aligned and ship reliably

Front-End Software Engineer - Synap ***Nov 2021 - Nov 2022***

Contributed to a large SaaS platform serving a substantial user base, focusing on UI quality and cross-functional collaboration.

- Made targeted contributions to REST APIs in a TypeScript monolith and integrated them into the front end in Ember.js, bridging back-end and UI concerns across a full-stack codebase
- Improved the user experience through targeted UI component edits and CSS animations, helping maintain a polished product for a substantial user base
- Translated business priorities into technical decisions by working directly with Product, Sales, and Customer Support to sequence and scope work
- Navigated technical constraints in stakeholder conversations, negotiating feasible solutions without derailing product timelines

Front-End Developer - Bewonder* ***Feb 2020 - Nov 2021***

Delivered client websites and internal tooling in a fast-paced agency environment.

- Built and maintained WordPress sites across a diverse client portfolio, delivering to brief and on schedule
- Leveraged the WordPress REST API to extend and customise site functionality, making targeted back-end changes to support client requirements
- Collaborated with designers, project managers, and marketers to deliver cohesive projects end-to-endDesigned and developed a suite of internal tools that automated time-consuming manual processes,including a tool to automate formatting of WiFi signup data from mailing list forms, saving over a day of manual data entry per month
- Provided mentorship and training to other team members, sharing knowledge and best practices

SOCIAL

benjamin-rutledge-03a331174
ben-rutledge-dev

CORE SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks

JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Ember.js

Styling & Design

CSS, Tailwind, CSS Modules, Styled Components, Sass, Figma, Adobe suite

Testing & Quality

Jest, Mocha, Chai

Tools & Workflow

Git, Husky, GitHub Workflows, Azure Boards, Shortcut

CMS & Other

WordPress

EDUCATION

Northcoders

Full Stack Development Bootcamp

Sep 2019 - Dec 2019

Intensive full-stack JavaScript course covering fundamental programming concepts, industry-standard practices including pair programming, test-driven development, and Git version control.

Leeds Beckett University

English Literature B.A. (Hons)

- Achieved first class honours
- Won prize for highest overall mark on the course

LANGUAGES

- English (native)
- Spanish (fluent)